SkillNavora

MODULE 3 HANDBOOK

Module 3: SFMC Account Setup, Navigation and Administration

4 sections, 31 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

Varun Kumar · SkillNavora · skillnavora.in
Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

Module 3: SFMC Account Setup, Navigation and Administration

Level: Beginner. How an SFMC account is set up with business units, users, sender authentication and governance.

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Detailed lessons

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3.1 Business units, the MID and account structure

WHAT IS IT?

> An SFMC account can hold an enterprise account with a parent business unit and child business units. Each business unit has its own MID (Marketing Cloud ID) and separate sending, data and assets, unless shared.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> The business unit design controls who sees which data and which sender domain is used. It is hard to change later, so design it first.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. List the brands or countries that need separate sending and data.
2. Create one child business unit per brand or country that needs isolation.
3. Decide which data extensions and assets are shared at parent level.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A group with two brands uses two child business units, each with its own sender profile and subscriber lists.

COMMON ERRORS

Creating too many business units, which splits data and makes reporting harder.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What is a business unit and why would you create one?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Draw a business unit design for a company with three brands and one shared footer library.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Help: Marketing Cloud Engagement

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3.2 Users, roles, sender authentication and delivery settings

WHAT IS IT?

> Users get roles and permission sets that decide what they can do in each business unit. Sender authentication (SPF, DKIM, and a branded tracking domain where used) proves to mailbox providers that a sender is legitimate. Sender and delivery profiles hold the From name, address and reply settings.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Poor authentication causes emails to land in spam and damages the sending reputation of the whole account.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Create users with the least permissions they need.
2. Set up sender authentication with the DNS records provided by SFMC.
3. Create a sender profile and a delivery profile for each brand.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> Adding the DKIM record in DNS and checking it in SFMC before the first campaign.

COMMON ERRORS

Sending from a domain you have not authenticated.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What does sender authentication protect against?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write a checklist of the DNS records and the SFMC settings needed before the first send.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Help: sender authentication

3.1 Account Setup: every topic explained

SFMC account provisioning. Salesforce sets up the account and stack when the licence is bought; admins then configure it.

Enterprise account. The top-level account that contains the parent business unit.

Business units. Separate working units under the enterprise account.

MID. Each business unit's numeric member ID, used in APIs and support.

Parent and child business units. The parent holds shared items; children inherit what is shared and keep their own data.

Account configuration. Settings such as time zone, locale, sender defaults and security.

Account settings. Account-wide options set in Setup, including password and session policies.

3.2 User Administration: every topic explained

User creation. Admins create users with username, email, role and business unit access.

User management. Updating, deactivating and auditing users as people join and leave.

Roles. Predefined or custom groups of permissions (for example, Marketing Cloud Administrator, Content Editor).

Permissions. Fine-grained rights such as create, edit, delete, send and export.

Permission sets. Bundles of permissions assigned in addition to roles where the account supports them.

User access. Which business units and tools each user can open.

Multi-factor authentication. A second check (app or code) at login. Required for many Salesforce products.

Login security. Policies for passwords, session timeouts, IP allow-lists and login monitoring.

3.3 Setup and Configuration: every topic explained

Sender authentication. Proves the sender owns the domain using DNS records so mailbox providers trust the mail.

Sender profiles. From name and address used on sends.

Delivery profiles. Delivery settings: IP address, header and footer used on sends.

Send classifications. Combines sender profile, delivery profile and commercial or transactional type for a send.

Reply mail management. Handles replies to sends: forward, auto-reply, or process unsubscribes from replies.

Domain configuration. Configures the sending and tracking domains in DNS.

Private domains. A domain you own and authenticate for sending, instead of a shared domain.

Dedicated IP concepts. A dedicated IP is used only by your account; reputation then depends only on your sending.

Account-level settings. Global settings such as default sender, tracking options and data retention defaults.

3.4 Administration and Governance: every topic explained

Business unit governance. Rules for who creates business units, what is shared, and how changes are approved.

Folder structures. A consistent folder tree for content, data extensions and automations.

Naming conventions. Name patterns such as DE_Customers_Master or EM_Welcome_01 that make assets findable.

Access management. Regular review of users and roles; remove access that is no longer needed.

Asset management. Managing asset creation, reuse, versioning and archiving.

Audit considerations. Keep a record of changes, sends and access for audits.

Configuration management. Documenting settings and changes so environments can be rebuilt or compared.